Nikola Stojkovski

Senior Software Engineer | .NET, C#, Azure
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SUMMARY

Senior software engineer with 9+ years of experience building backend systems in C#, ASP.NET Core and Azure, with domain depth in payroll and payments and real-time EV charging platforms. As Tech Lead of a 5-engineer team, designed an EV charging platform from the ground up, including a YARP-based routing architecture for real-time WebSocket traffic from 4,000+ chargers. Skilled in event-driven architecture (RabbitMQ, Azure Service Bus), Domain-Driven Design, Terraform and CI/CD with Azure DevOps. Stack-agnostic beyond .NET, with hands-on experience in Python and Node.js, and an early adopter of AI-assisted development (Claude Code). Microsoft Certified: Azure Developer Associate (AZ-204).

SKILLS

Backend
C#, .NET 8/9, ASP.NET Core (Web API), Entity Framework Core, MediatR, REST APIs, WebSockets, OAuth 2.0, RBAC

Architecture
Microservices, Domain-Driven Design (DDD), Event-Driven Architecture, CQRS, YARP

Cloud & DevOps
Microsoft Azure, App Service, API Management, Azure SQL, Azure Functions, Blob Storage, Application Insights, Azure DevOps (YAML Pipelines), Terraform, CI/CD, Docker

Data & Messaging
SQL Server / T-SQL, PostgreSQL, Azure Cosmos DB, RabbitMQ, Azure Service Bus

AI-Assisted Development
Claude Code (custom skills), GitHub Copilot, MCP servers

Testing
NUnit, xUnit, Test-Driven Development (TDD), integration testing (Testcontainers), Grafana k6 (load testing)

Frontend
Angular (NgRx), Vue.js, DevExtreme, React, TypeScript

WORK EXPERIENCE

PaySpace (a Deel company) Cape Town, South Africa (Remote)
Senior Full Stack Engineer Nov 2024 – Present
Multi-country payroll and HR platform, acquired by Deel in 2024

- Built new country-specific payroll features, extending the platform's support for international markets.
- Migrated business logic from SQL Server stored procedures into the .NET backend, moving it into testable, version-controlled C# services.
- Led the front-end modernization from legacy ASP.NET MVC to Vue.js with DevExtreme, rewriting existing modules as modern components.
- Improved the performance and reliability of distributed payroll background processing using .NET, EF Core and RabbitMQ.
- Built Grafana k6 load tests for payroll APIs and background processing to find performance bottlenecks and verify improvements before release.
- Created custom Claude Code skills for building new Vue.js/DevExtreme screens according to project conventions, and used AI-assisted development in daily delivery.

Metergram Florida, USA (Remote)
Senior Software Engineer (Tech Lead) Sep 2022 – Oct 2024
EV charging management platform (CPMS)

- Led a team of 5 engineers as Technical Lead, owning technical direction, planning, code reviews and mentoring.
- Designed the platform architecture from the ground up and set up the repository, CI/CD pipelines and Azure infrastructure as code with Terraform (App Services, Service Bus, SQL databases, Key Vault, Application Insights).

- Implemented OCPP 1.6J over persistent WebSocket connections for real-time communication with 4,000+ chargers.
- Designed a YARP-based routing layer to distribute high-volume WebSocket traffic across backend services, and validated it with Grafana k6 load tests simulating concurrent charger connections.
- Integrated 5 roaming partner platforms via OCPI 2.1.1 for real-time charging sessions and tariff exchange.
- Represented Metergram at the OCPP 2.0.1 Plugfest in Arnhem, running interoperability tests with manufacturers.

Melon Skopje, Macedonia
Senior Software Engineer Sep 2021 – Aug 2022
Software development outsourcing company (now part of Kin + Carta)

- Designed and set up the platform's Azure architecture using Azure Functions and Azure Cosmos DB.
- Integrated Dwolla payment infrastructure for ACH transfers, bank account verification and KYC workflows.
- Migrated scheduling services from .NET Framework to .NET 6, improving maintainability and scalability.
- Implemented OAuth 2.0 authentication and authorization for secure enterprise access management.
- Built web and mobile front-end features with Angular and Ionic.

MCA Skopje, Macedonia
Software Developer → Senior Full Stack Engineer Apr 2018 – Aug 2021
Software development partner for Scandinavian and European product companies

- Developed 4 payroll microservices for Zenegy covering Denmark, Switzerland and Sweden, following Domain-Driven Design with CQRS and MediatR, each service owning an isolated SQL Server database.
- Implemented country-specific payroll and tax calculation logic in C#/.NET using Test-Driven Development (TDD) to ensure calculation accuracy.
- Built Angular front-end workflows with NgRx for complex state management, such as multi-step payroll configuration.

PNA Technology Skopje, Macedonia
Software Developer Nov 2016 – Mar 2018

- Built the real-time data-visualization layer for E-metrix, an industrial IoT platform measuring Overall Equipment Effectiveness (OEE) in factories: Angular dashboards showing machine availability, performance drops and product defects streamed via SignalR and MQTT.
- Developed web applications using ASP.NET MVC, Python (Flask), jQuery and SQLite.

TEACHING

Brainster Skopje, Macedonia
Lecturer Sep 2020 – Apr 2021

- Designed the curriculum for .NET and Node.js backend development courses and taught multiple student groups.
- Mentored students through hands-on final projects, from initial design to completion.

CERTIFICATIONS

Microsoft Certified: Azure Developer Associate (AZ-204) Jul 2023

EDUCATION

Ss. Cyril and Methodius University, Faculty of Computer Science and Engineering (FINKI)
Bachelor of Science in Information Science (Computer Science and Engineering)
Skopje, Macedonia • Oct 2014 – Mar 2019
Thesis: IoT garden monitoring with .NET, MQTT, Raspberry Pi

LANGUAGES

English (Professional proficiency)

Macedonian (Native)